Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Tuesday, 20 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light rain	Light rain	Light rain	Light rain
13° 11°	11° 10°	12° 11°	12° 9°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The trial of Russell Brand has heard a woman describe closing her eyes and trying 'not to be there' during an alleged rape.**

The 51-year-old comedian and actor faces three counts of rape, three charges of sexual assault, and one of indecent assault. He denies all the allegations.

CRIME · UK

2 **Four people have been arrested after a police officer was shot and injured in the line of duty.**

The officer was shot in the foot and is currently in hospital, thankfully in a stable condition. Investigations are ongoing following the incident.

CRIME · UK

3 **The Prime Minister has called youth unemployment a 'catastrophe and a moral failure' facing the UK.**

With one million young people currently not in work or training, the PM highlighted the urgent need for action. It's a significant challenge for the country's economic future.

POLITICS · UK

4 **A BBC investigation has uncovered companies allegedly exploiting the welfare system by using residents as 'cash cows'.**

These agents are reportedly using social media videos to attract people on housing benefit, offering free rooms and even holidays. It raises serious concerns about vulnerable individuals being targeted.

SOCIAL AFFAIRS · UK

5 **Home sellers are cutting asking prices on around 3,000 properties every single day, according to new data.**

This marks the highest number of price reductions in 15 years, suggesting a significant shift in the housing market. It could be good news for potential buyers.

PROPERTY · UK

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02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Good news for fans of The Simpsons, as Apu Nahasapeemapetilon is set to return with a new voice after an eight-year absence!**

The much-loved Kwik-E-Mart owner has been seen in Springfield, but not heard, since 2018. This marks a new chapter for the character following a past race row.

ON AIR — What's a classic TV character you'd love to see make a comeback?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Turkish girl group Manifest are heading to Wembley Arena for their first UK concert, marking a huge milestone in their turbulent year!**

They've gone from reality TV to a global audience in just twelve months. It's a fantastic journey for the group, ready to take the stage in London.

ON AIR — What's the best concert you've ever been to?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

3 **The new 'Street Fighter' movie is hitting screens, with its creators promising it's 'made by fans for fans'!**

Cast members Noah Centineo and Andrew Koji are among those hoping to 'KO the critics' with this latest video game adaptation. Will it live up to the hype?

ON AIR — What's your favourite video game adaptation, or which game would you love to see on the big screen?

FILM · COMING UP

4 **Still not sure what to wear for Halloween? Some popular costume trends have been revealed for this year!**

Expect to see lots of 'Freaky Nikki', Dolly Parton, and even whimsical gargoyles among adults dressing up. Time to get those spooky outfits ready!

ON AIR — What's the best Halloween costume you've ever worn or seen?

CULTURE · THIS WEEK

5 **Singer Lola Young has shared that vaping has made breathing feel like a 'chore', impacting her health.**

The 'Messy' singer revealed her lungs now feel 'battery powered' due to the effects of vaping. It's a stark warning about the potential health consequences.

ON AIR — Have you or anyone you know experienced unexpected health issues from vaping?

HEALTH · NOW

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Cristiano Ronaldo has been handed a 30-day suspension by the Portuguese Football Federation.**

The ban comes after he controversially left his country's international camp last month. This will keep him off the pitch for a significant period.

ON AIR — Is a 30-day ban fair for an international player leaving a camp early?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England manager Sarina Wiegman has signed a contract extension, committing her future to the Lionesses!**

She says she 'cannot think of a better job in football' as she extends her stay until after Euro 2029. Fantastic news for women's football in England!

ON AIR — How important is Sarina Wiegman to the Lionesses' continued success?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Leicester City are set to visit National League North side Oxford City in the FA Cup first round!**

It's a classic FA Cup tie, five years after Leicester famously won the competition. Oxford City will be hoping for a giant-killing.

ON AIR — Who do you think will pull off the biggest upset in the FA Cup first round?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Everton legend Duncan Ferguson is returning to management, taking charge of Irish Premiership club Glentoran!**

The former Everton and Rangers striker is a popular figure and will be looking to make his mark in the Irish League. Big Dunc is back!

ON AIR — Which former Premier League player would you love to see return to management?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Ronnie O'Sullivan's poor form continues, as he was beaten in the Northern Ireland Open by Ka Wai Cheung.**

The seven-time world champion lost in a deciding frame in the first round. It's another early exit for 'The Rocket'.

ON AIR — Is Ronnie O'Sullivan past his prime, or can he still challenge for major titles?

SNOOKER · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1. **A recent study suggests that a brisk walk in a local park could be just as good for boosting creativity as a dedicated brainstorming session.**
   Researchers found that participants who took a short stroll outdoors often returned with more innovative ideas than those who stayed indoors. It seems fresh air truly helps clear the mind!

2. **The unexpected joy of 'discovering a forgotten fiver' in an old coat pocket is apparently a universal delight.**
   A small survey found that this minor financial windfall brings a disproportionate amount of happiness, often described as 'better than finding a tenner you expected'.

3. **Experts are highlighting the quiet charm of 'early morning garden dew' as a surprising source of peace.**
   Observing the delicate droplets on leaves and spiderwebs is being touted as a simple, mindful practice to start the day calmly. Just remember your wellies!

4. **There's a growing trend of 'swapping surplus garden produce' with neighbours, fostering community spirit and reducing waste.**
   From courgettes to colossal pumpkins, local Facebook groups and street noticeboards are buzzing with exchanges, ensuring no good vegetable goes uneaten.

5. **The comforting ritual of 'listening to the rain against the window' is being recognised for its stress-reducing qualities.**
   Many are finding the gentle patter a perfect soundtrack for reading, relaxing, or just quietly contemplating. It's nature's own white noise.

6. **A new appreciation for 'vintage British seaside postcards' is capturing the imagination of collectors and nostalgic types.**
   These charming glimpses into holidays past, with their faded colours and quaint messages, are becoming treasured mementos of simpler times.

7. **The simple pleasure of 'successfully peeling an orange in one go' is bringing small moments of triumph to many.**
   Social media is awash with people sharing their perfect peels, celebrating this minor but satisfying domestic achievement. It's the little things, isn't it?

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to quietly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING THE BAG A GENTLE SHAKE TO GAUGE THE 'CRISP-TO-AIR RATIO' BEFORE BUYING!

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of chocolate, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: CAREFULLY BREAKING OFF A TINY CORNER JUST TO SMELL IT PROPERLY BEFORE EATING!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday smell' just instantly makes you feel a bit nostalgic or takes you back to a specific time?**
  Perhaps it's the smell of freshly cut grass reminding you of childhood summers, or a particular cleaning product that evokes memories of your grandmother's house. What are those everyday smells that transport you back in time, and why?

- **We all have those 'little acts of kindness' that we've either given or received that just made our day, or even our week.**
  Maybe it was someone letting you go ahead in a queue, a neighbour offering help, or a stranger's unexpected compliment. What's the most memorable small act of kindness you've experienced or given, and how did it make you feel?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Did you know that the world's first ever postage stamp, the Penny Black, was issued in the UK in 1840 and featured a profile of Queen Victoria?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that before clocks became widely available, some villages in England employed a 'knocker-upper' whose job it was to tap on people's windows with a long stick to ensure they woke up on time for work?

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance', perfectly describing their vibrant appearance.
- The distinctive red telephone boxes in the UK were designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott, who also designed Battersea Power Station.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have even found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- The 'richest' soil on Earth is called 'chernozem', found in regions like Ukraine and Russia, and is incredibly fertile.
- Mount Everest, the world's highest peak, grows taller by a few millimetres each year due to geological forces.
- The unique pattern of stripes on a zebra is as individual as a human fingerprint, with no two zebras having the exact same markings.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES TUE 20 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 293 of the year, 72 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Acca of Hexham; Christian feast days: Aderald; Christian feast days: Artemius; Christian feast days: Caprasius of Agen. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1961 — Ian Rush, Welsh footballer and manager
- 1934 — Timothy West, English actor (died 2024)
- 1937 — Wanda Jackson, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1976 — Dan Fogler, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1974 — Limmy, Scottish comedian and writer
- 1941 — Anneke Wills, English actress
- 1999 — YoungBoy Never Broke Again, American rapper
- 1984 — Mitch Lucker, American singer-songwriter (died 2012)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1944 — World War II: The Soviet Red Army and Yugoslav Partisans liberate Belgrade.
- 1986 — Aeroflot Flight 6502 crashes while landing at Kuibyshev Airport (now Kuromoch International Airport) in Kuibyshev (now present-day Samara, Russia), killing 70 people.
- 1948 — A KLM Lockheed L-049 Constellation crashes on approach to Glasgow Prestwick Airport, killing 40.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1981 — Two police officers and a Brink's armored car guard are killed during an armed robbery carried out by members of the Black Liberation Army and Weather Underground in Nanuet, New York.
- 1991 — A massive firestorm breaks out in the hills of Oakland and Berkeley, California killing 25 people and destroying more than 3,000 homes, apartments and condominiums.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1973 — Watergate scandal: "Saturday Night Massacre": United States President Richard Nixon fires U.S. Attorney General Elliot Richardson and Deputy Attorney General William Ruckelshaus after they refuse to fire special prosecutor Archibald Cox, who is finally fired by Solicitor Gener...
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1951 — The "Johnny Bright incident" occurs during a football game between the Drake Bulldogs and Oklahoma A&M Aggies.

- 1991 — A 6.8 Mw earthquake strikes the Uttarkashi region of India, killing more than 1,000 people.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES WED 21 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 294 of the year, 71 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Honduras); Christian feast day: Céline of Laon; Christian feast day: Blessed Charles of Austria (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Fintán of Taghmon. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — Conor O'Shea, Irish rugby player and coach
- 1976 — Jeremy Miller, American actor and singer
- 1988 — Glen Powell, American actor
- 1944 — Mandy Rice-Davies, English model and actress (died 2014)
- 1945 — Everett McGill, American actor
- 1995 — Doja Cat, American rapper, singer and songwriter
- 1989 — Luke Murphy, English footballer
- 1976 — Josh Ritter, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2003 — Images of the dwarf planet Eris are taken and subsequently used in documenting its discovery.
- 1987 — The Jaffna hospital massacre is carried out by Indian peacekeeping forces in Sri Lanka, killing 70 Tamil patients, doctors and nurses.
- 1986 — In Lebanon, pro-Iran kidnappers claim to have abducted American writer Edward Tracy (he is released in August 1991).

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2011 — Iraq War: President Barack Obama announces that the withdrawal of United States troops from Iraq will be complete by the end of the year.
- 1966 — A colliery spoil tip slips onto houses and a school in the village of Aberfan in Wales, killing 144 people, 116 of whom were schoolchildren.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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